

Beginner Half Marathon Plan

A 10-week plan designed for first-time half marathoners and runners returning to distance. No junk miles. No overwhelm. Just consistent, progressive work that gets you to the finish line strong.

10

WEEK PROGRAM

13.1

MILES RACE DAY

3

RUNS PER WEEK

PR

THE ONLY GOAL

WHO THIS IS FOR

Your first 13.1 miles. Done right.

This plan is for runners who want to complete their first half marathon — or come back after a break and finally cross the finish line without falling apart. It's built around one thing: showing up consistently.

Three runs per week. A long run on Saturday that builds progressively. Optional strength or recovery on Sunday. No complicated workouts. No pace anxiety. Just miles.

— No base required

You should be able to run/walk 3 miles comfortably before starting. If you can do that, this plan will take care of the rest.

— Time commitment

3 runs per week plus optional Sunday recovery. Longest run is 12 miles in Week 7.

— Pace guidance

All runs are easy or steady. Easy = conversational. Steady = slightly harder but you can still talk in short sentences.

— The only goal

Finish. Cross the line feeling strong. Everything else — pace, time, place — comes later.

THE STRUCTURE

Simple. Progressive. Effective.

WEEKS 1-3

Build the Base

Short easy runs, long run starts at 8 miles. Your body adapts to consistent mileage.

WEEK 4

Deload

Mileage drops to let your body recover and absorb the work.

WEEKS 5-7

Build to Peak

Long run climbs to 12 miles. Tuesday runs add a slight pace pickup.

WEEK 8

Second Deload

Pull back again before the final push.

WEEK 9

Taper

Volume drops. Legs freshen. Confidence builds.

WEEK 10

Race Week

Short easy runs. Race day Sunday.

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
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Week 1

BASE BUILDING

MON Optional Easy 1–3 miles	TUE Easy Run 2.5 miles	WED Rest	THU Easy Run 3 miles	FRI Rest	SAT Long Run 8 miles	SUN Recovery
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Week 2

BASE BUILDING

MON Optional Easy 1–3 miles	TUE Easy Run 3 miles	WED Rest	THU Steady Run 3 miles	FRI Rest	SAT Long Run 9 miles	SUN Recovery
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Week 3

BASE BUILDING

MON Optional Easy 1–3 miles	TUE Easy Run 3 miles	WED Rest	THU Steady Run 4 miles	FRI Rest	SAT Long Run 10 miles	SUN Recovery
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Week 4

DELOAD WEEK

MON Optional Easy 1–3 miles	TUE Easy Run 2 miles	WED Rest	THU Steady Run 3 miles	FRI Rest	SAT Long Run 7 miles	SUN Recovery
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Week 5

BUILD PHASE

MON Optional Easy 1–3 miles	TUE Easy Run 3.5 miles	WED Rest	THU Steady Run 4 miles Last mile slightly faster	FRI Rest	SAT Long Run 11 miles	SUN Recovery
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MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT	SUN
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Week 6

BUILD PHASE

MON Optional Easy 1–3 miles	TUE Easy Run 3.5 miles	WED Rest	THU Easy Run 4 miles	FRI Rest	SAT Long Run 8 miles	SUN Recovery
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Week 7

PEAK WEEK

MON Optional Easy 1–3 miles	TUE Easy Run 3 miles	WED Rest	THU Steady Run 4.5 miles	FRI Rest	SAT Long Run 12 miles	SUN Recovery
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Week 8

DELOAD WEEK

MON Optional Easy 1–3 miles	TUE Easy Run 3.5 miles	WED Rest	THU Easy Run 4 miles	FRI Rest	SAT Long Run 9 miles	SUN Recovery
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Week 9

TAPER WEEK

MON Optional Easy 1–3 miles	TUE Easy Run 2.5 miles	WED Rest	THU Easy Run 3 miles	FRI Rest	SAT Long Run 6 miles	SUN Recovery
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Week 10

RACE WEEK

MON Optional Easy 1–3 miles	TUE Easy Run 2.5 miles	WED Rest	THU Easy Run 2 miles	FRI Shakeout Run 1–3 miles	SAT Rest	SUN RACE DAY 13.1 miles GOAL: Finish Strong Trust your training.
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A NOTE FROM COACH TYLER

Every PR starts somewhere.

Your first half marathon is a big deal. Not because 13.1 miles is easy — it's not — but because deciding to do something hard and following through on it changes how you see yourself.

This plan doesn't ask you to be fast. It asks you to be consistent. Show up three times a week, do your long run on Saturday, and trust that the miles add up. They do.

When you cross that finish line, you'll be an athlete who ran 13.1 miles. Nobody can take that from you. And once you have it, you'll want more.

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